

Family Petroicidae

Australasian robins

Length 4¼–7 in (11–18 cm)

Species 49



One group of these birds has red breasts that may have reminded settlers of the European robin, hence their common name. Like the robin, these small birds have an upright stance, and occasionally flick their drooping tail. The 2 sexes are often different, the female being drabber. This tree-living family generally feeds on the ground on insects and their larvae, or sallies forth



upright stance



NORFOLK ROBIN

Found in southeast and southwest Australia, and eastern Tasmania, *Petroica multicolor* occurs in eucalyptus, but moves to a more open habitat in autumn. It is 4¼–5½ in (12–14 cm) long, and darts from a stump or low branch to seize prey, such as caterpillars, on the ground.

after flying insects. The nest, a tiny cup of moss bound by spiders' webs, is placed on a branch. The female lays 2–4 pale blue or green eggs with red-brown to violet spots, and is known to incubate them herself for 12–14 days. Many species of Australasian robins are partial migrants.

BLACK ROBIN

Petroica traversi has come back from the brink of extinction on the Chatham Islands, east of New Zealand. Once common on 4 islands, it was nearly wiped out by introduced cats. By 1976, there were only 7 birds left. Their population was boosted by captive-breeding methods.

Family Paridae

Tits, Chickadees

Length 4¼–9 in (11–22 cm)

Species 64



Many species in this family have adapted to life with humans—they come readily to bird feeders and often use nestboxes for breeding. Found across North and Central America, Europe, Africa, and Asia, these small, acrobatic birds can pluck insects from foliage, or peck at peanuts inside hanging feeders. In autumn and winter, a number of species form mixed-foraging flocks and move along hedgerows, uttering frequent calls, as they search for insects. True tits generally nest in tree holes or nestboxes, lining these with moss before laying a large clutch. The eggs are incubated for 13–14 days and the nestlings fledge in 17–20 days.



BLACK-CAPPED CHICKADEE

The most widespread North American tit, *Parus atricapillus* is one of 6 species named after their "chick-a-dee-dee-dee" call. This bird is 5 in (13 cm) long. In spring, it finds a mate and digs a nest hole in a dead stump, where the female lays 6–8 eggs in a cup of grass, moss, and feathers.

GREAT TIT

Parus major, 5½ in (14 cm) long, is a dominant tit at feeding stations in Europe. It flocks with other tits in winter, searching for insects, and also eats seeds and fruit. It has a large variety of calls and its song is a sequence of "tee-tee-tu" whistles. The female lays 5–11 white eggs that have reddish spots.



brown eyes



EURASIAN BLUE TIT

Highly acrobatic, *Cyanistes caeruleus* scours vegetation for insects and hangs upside-down to feed on seed hoppers. It nests in holes and nestboxes, laying 6–12 reddish-speckled white eggs. It is 4½ in (11.5 cm) long.

ASHY TIT

Found in southwest Africa, *Melaniparus cinerascens* is a bird of dry thorn savanna and Kalahari scrub. It often hangs upside-down when feeding. It is a restless bird, hopping from one branch to the next, and can tear acacia pods in search of insects.

Family Pycnonotidae

Bulbuls

Length 6–10½ in (15–27 cm)

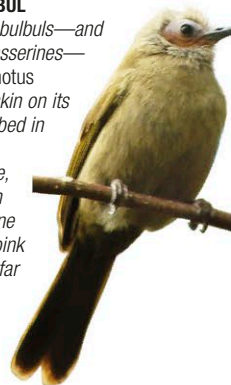
Species 152



Nearly half the bulbul species occurs in Africa—most making up a group of similar greenish-colored "greenbills" of the genera *Andropadus* and *Phyllastrephus*—but the majority of the family is found in Asia. These birds primarily inhabit forests, although some have adapted to more open, man-made habitats. The garden species are more gregarious and noisy than forest species. Often located and identified by their calls, few bulbuls have musical songs. Small- to medium-sized birds, many species have dull olive, brown,

BARE-FACED BULBUL

Distinctive among bulbuls—and unusual among passerines—this bulbul, *Pycnonotus hualon*, has bare skin on its face. It was described in 2009 after its discovery in sparse, shrubby vegetation on rugged limestone hills of Laos. The pink bare skin extends far behind its eyes, which are ringed with a tinge of blue.



coral red bill



BLACK BULBUL

Found in South and Southeast Asia, *Hypsipetes leucocephalus* is 9 in (23 cm) long. One subspecies from China and northern Vietnam has a white head and throat. This bird feeds on berries and insects in noisy flocks of up to 100. Its call resembles the cry of a kitten.

red patch behind eye

white throat

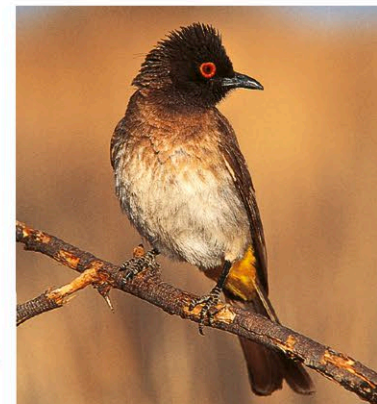
RED-WHISKERED BULBUL

The red patch behind the eye in both sexes gives *Pycnonotus jocosus* its common name. Its other trademark feature is a black, forward-pointing crest. A common garden bird, about 8 in (20 cm) in length, it occurs from India to Hong Kong.



white-tipped tail

or gray plumage, sometimes with yellow underparts. Some species have a crest and most have bristles around the base of the bill, which may curve downward toward the tip. Many bulbuls feed on fruit and berries or buds and nectar, some eat only insects, whereas others are omnivorous. The female usually lays 2 eggs per clutch, in a nest that tends to be open in structure to allow the tropical rain to drain through.



AFRICAN RED-EYED BULBUL

Found in Namibia, Botswana, and western South Africa, in forests near rivers and in dry bush near water, *Pycnonotus nigricans* is a noisy bird. About 8 in (20 cm) long, it nests from November to March, the female laying 3 pinkish eggs with dark markings.



YELLOW-STREAKED GREENBUL

Found in isolated locations, in mountain rain forests in central and southeast Africa, *Phyllastrephus flavostriatus* forages for insects, mainly in trees. Working its way round tree trunks like a woodpecker, it repeatedly flicks one wing at a time, revealing its yellow underwing. This bird is 6–10½ in (15–27 cm) long.